Digital Literacy Project Report [CSE 0001]

Student Digital Ambassador Portfolio

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Year: First year

Date: March 26, 2026

Introduction

In this project, I took on the responsibility of acting as a Student Digital Ambassador for the VIT Bhopal community. The primary goal was to develop a comprehensive portfolio that showcases not only technical proficiency but also a deep understanding of digital safety and professional ethics. Throughout the five modules of this course, I worked on building a professional identity across various platforms, practiced secure communication through formal email drafting, and researched prevalent cyber threats like UPI fraud. This report documents the process of creating these resources and reflects on how these digital literacy skills are essential for any modern student. By completing these tasks, I have established a strong foundation that will support my academic journey and my future career in technology.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I used Canva to design an infographic titled "The Digital Student's Playbook." I chose a dark blue, tech inspired theme with glowing visual elements to connect with a computer science aesthetic. The design highlights three crucial areas. The top section focuses on digital tools, emphasizing platforms like GitHub for version control—which is essential when managing code for projects like Minecraft mods—and Notion for organization. The middle section covers safe internet practices, pairing neon security icons with practical advice like using 2FA and verifying SDK downloads to avoid malware. The bottom section emphasizes building a professional online presence, showcasing how a well curated portfolio or GitHub profile can help attract potential collaborators or startup founders.

One interesting challenge during the design process was maintaining a clean visual hierarchy while fitting in all the necessary text. Balancing the glowing with the bullet points required careful alignment and spacing. I had to ensure the specific examples, like connecting with fellow students on Discord, didn't clutter the layout while still delivering clear, actionable advice.

Task 2: Building My Digital Portfolio

For my portfolio, I updated profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is a platform for version control and collaborative software development. Over the next four years of my Computer Science degree, I plan to use GitHub to manage the codebase for my projects, specifically hosting the repositories for my Minecraft Twitch integration mods and the core architecture of the university student collaboration platform I am developing. LinkedIn is a networking site used to build a professional presence and connect with industry peers. I will use LinkedIn to network with other startup founders, find ambitious students to collaborate with on my platform, and establish connections that will support the future launch of my compliance software tool. Finally, Kaggle is a community space for data science and machine learning. As my studies progress, I plan to use Kaggle to explore artificial intelligence models and analyze datasets. This will help me build the technical skills necessary to eventually

explore advanced fields like autonomous aviation and high-density battery technology. Together, these platforms will help me build a comprehensive technical portfolio and a strong professional network before graduation.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration Tools

For my coding practice, I used HackerRank to complete a beginner level challenge. Practicing on this platform helps me build the core algorithmic logic required for my B Tech Computer Science and Engineering coursework. It also strengthens my foundation for developing complex systems later, like the SDK for my Twitch integration platform. For the collaboration task, I built a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz tests my batchmates on identifying phishing emails, evaluating their confidence against online misinformation, understanding Two Factor Authentication, and creating strong passwords. I linked the form to Google Sheets to collect and analyze the responses. Learning how to properly structure surveys and analyze data using Google Workspace is incredibly useful academically. It allows me to conduct efficient research for university projects. Furthermore, mastering these data collection tools will directly help me when I need to gather user feedback to connect fellow students on my future collaboration platform or when doing market research for my startup ideas.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette

In Task 4, I practiced the art of professional digital communication. I drafted two formal emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor due to a technical development issue, and another inquiring about a summer internship. These drafts focused on maintaining a respectful tone, using clear subject lines, and providing all necessary details like my registration number. Alongside the emails, I developed a” Social Media Checklist” that outlines five” Do’s” and five” Don’ts” for university students. This included advice on auditing privacy settings and avoiding the trap of public arguments or” trolling.” This task highlighted that even a highly skilled programmer can face setbacks if they lack the ability to communicate professionally. I now understand that every email or social media post is a reflection of my professional character, and taking the time to proofread and set the right tone is essential.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

The final task involved a deep dive into UPI” Collect Request” Fraud, a cybercrime that frequently targets students and young adults in India. I researched how scammers use psychological pressure and social engineering to trick people into entering their UPI PIN to” receive”

money, which is a fundamental misunderstanding of how UPI works. To help prevent this, I created a checklist emphasizing that a PIN is only ever required for sending funds, never for receiving them. I also included critical information on how to report such incidents to the National Cyber Crime Portal and the 1930 helpline. This research was eye-opening because it showed me that technical knowledge isn't always enough to prevent fraud; one must also stay alert to the social tactics' scammers use. Being a Digital Ambassador means staying updated on these threats and sharing that knowledge to protect others in the community.

Conclusion

Completing this project has been a valuable experience that changed how I view my online presence. I have moved from being a casual user of digital tools to a more intentional and professional digital citizen. Whether it was securing my accounts with 2FA, presenting my skills on GitHub, or learning the nuances of professional email etiquette, each task has added a new layer to my digital literacy. I feel much more prepared to navigate the challenges of the tech industry and to act as a resource for others who may need guidance in staying safe online. These skills are not just for a course; they are life skills that will continue to evolve as technology changes.